

GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT

OFFICIAL MINUTES — WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 26, 2026

The Grimes County Commissioners Court met on Wednesday, August 26, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

Call to Order

Joe Fauth called the meeting to order at 9:00 AM on Wednesday, August 26, 2026, at 270 FM 149 West, Anderson, Texas, noting that notice of the regular commissioners court meeting had been posted in accordance with statute and that the court was 100 percent present.

Public Comments

Joe Fauth inquired whether any commissioners had public comments, and hearing none from Chad Mallett, David Tullos, Phillip Cox, and others present, he proceeded to the next agenda item.

We look forward to hearing from the citizens of Grimes County. If you wish to make public comments you will need to submit a Public Participation Form prior to the start of the meeting and give it to the County Clerk. Public comments will be limited to 2 minutes per person.

Grimes County Treasurer - Tom Maynard (JF)

1 Review and take action regarding a missing receipt on an expense report submitted to Accounts Payable. — Tom Maynard, Grimes County Treasurer

The county treasurer Tom Maynard, explained the process for handling expense reports with receipts, noting that occasionally receipts fail to scan properly, particularly narrow restaurant receipts that can stick together and disappear during the scanning process. Mr. Maynard stated that in this instance, an employee's receipt was distinctly remembered by staff as being present but did not appear in the scanned backup documentation, and requested payment with the employee held accountable. Jessi Murphy clarified that Accounts Payable's responsibility is to ensure compliance with county policy by verifying coding and funding availability, and that because no backup documentation was present when the report arrived at their office, they could not verify the expense and brought the matter before the court. The disputed amount was \$16. Phillip Cox moved to approve payment. Joe Fauth raised concern about the cost-benefit of convening the court at over \$400 per hour to address a \$16 discrepancy and asked whether a notarized statement from the county treasurer could substitute for the missing receipt. Jessi Murphy responded that the policy, adopted by the commissioners court, requires backup receipts and that any change to this requirement would need to come through policy revision. Chad Mallett suggested that original scans be retained for a period of time to prevent similar issues in the future. Joe Fauth reiterated his concern about the expense of the court process relative to the amount in question but acknowledged that Jessi Murphy was doing her job and that policy compliance required the matter to be brought before the court. The motion to approve by Phillip Cox. Seconded by Michael Raska. Carried (5-0-0)

Grimes County Elections Administrator - Rachel Walker (JF)

2 Consider and take action to approve the 2026 National Voter Registration Day Resolution and declare September 15, 2026 as National Voter Registration Day, and authorize the County Judge as signatory. — Rachel Walker, Grimes County Elections Administrator

Rachel Walker, Grimes County elections administrator, presented the resolution to declare

September 15, 2026 as National Voter Registration Day. Walker explained that the county conducts this annual observance to inform the public of the official designation and read the resolution, which emphasized the fundamental right to vote, the importance of voter registration as an essential first step in the democratic process, and the county's commitment to promoting election integrity, voter education, and accessibility. The resolution noted that National Voter Registration Day has been observed nationally since 2012 and brings together election officials, civic organizations, schools, libraries, businesses, and community partners to encourage eligible citizens to register to vote and maintain accurate registration information. Chad Mallett moved to approve the resolution and authorize the county judge as signatory. Seconded by Phillip Cox. Carried (5-0-0)

See [Exhibit A](#).

3 Present information to the Court regarding the 2026 Grimes County Voter Sticker Design Contest. — Rachel Walker, Grimes County Elections Administrator

Rachel Walker presented information about the 2026 Grimes County Voter Sticker Design Contest, which is being held every two years and marks the second iteration of the program. She reported that the first contest generated overwhelming citizen engagement and positive public feedback. The contest is accepting entries until September 9, after which a panel of judges will evaluate the submissions and announce winners on National Voter Registration Day. Both first-place winners' designs will be created as stickers distributed to citizens at the polls. Rachel Walker noted two changes for this year's contest: the I Voted sticker outline will now feature the shape of Grimes County instead of a circle, allowing children to create art within the county's boundaries, and facilities director Rodney Floyd suggested displaying the first-place winner on the side of the new election trailer to showcase it throughout the county. Rachel Walker indicated that entry forms and packets are available in her office for citizens without printers, and she confirmed that all Grimes County school district superintendents, principals, assistant principals, and art teachers have been notified and provided stacks of materials to distribute to students.

4 Consider and take action to approve the purchase of additional technology equipment for the Elections Department using Election Contract Surplus Funds. — Rachel Walker, Grimes County Elections Administrator

Rachel Walker presented a request to purchase two Microsoft Surface tablets for the Elections Department using election contract surplus funds in the amount of \$3,900. Walker explained that the tablets would expand technology capabilities in the office and enhance support provided on election day, particularly to improve communication between the Elections Department and polling locations. She noted the tablets would enable multiple workstations for temporary staff to handle voter inquiries and polling location calls, and would strengthen technology support year-round. Walker indicated the purchase would be funded through surplus funds collected from contracted elections rather than the general fund, which are approved expenses from Fund 55. Chad Mallett moved to approve the request, and Joe Fauth seconded the motion. Carried (5-0-0) The Auditor requested to have Ms Walker come back to advise her office and the Court where the funds will come from to cover the purchase. Ms Walker stated that whatever line items have money available can be put into line item 4505 to cover the \$3,900. Commissioner Tullos asked Ms Walker if she was sure that she will not be needing any of the money in other line items before the end of September. Ms Walker answered she would not.

Action: Commissioner Mallett amended his motion to include the funding and allow the Auditor to make the necessary changes. Judge Fauth senconded. Carried (5-0-0)

Grimes County Judge - Joe Fauth III

5 Discuss and take action on any issue regarding FY 27 Proposed Budget. — Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

The court discussed the FY 2027 proposed budget at considerable length, addressing numerous line items and departmental requests. Jessi Murphy presented grand totals reflecting several changes made since the initial proposal, including a reduction in one line item from \$43,143.54 to \$140,000, adjustments to DA investigator positions for correct tenure and grade, the addition of jail deputies and animal control positions under a new law enforcement structure totaling approximately \$24,000, and the reinstatement of investigators' stipends under SB 22 for a \$6,300 change. Atina Adair presented merit increase parameters recommending that the \$2 merit be tied to a five-point performance rating system, with employees rated three receiving 50–75% of the allotted merit, fours receiving 75–100%, and fives receiving 100%, while those rated two would be placed on performance improvement plans. Following extensive discussion on the EMC fire marshal position, the court approved an 85–15 funding split between the fire marshal restricted fund and the EMC fund and determined to address the position title prior to budget adoption. The court also decided to add a certificate pay line for the fire marshal position and approved changing the law enforcement deputy structure from four patrol deputies to three patrol deputies and one CID investigator, funded through SB 22 resources. On step-and-grade implementation, the court directed that step increases take effect at the beginning of a payroll period rather than mid-year to reduce administrative burden, with the auditor and HR to establish parameters. The court allocated \$8,160.61 in remaining SB 22 funds to help offset the cost of two ADA positions budgeted at \$130,000 each. Regarding capital projects, the court budgeted \$2,350,000 in expenditures, comprising \$1,500,000 for capital improvements and \$850,000 for architectural design of a potential jail renovation or rebuild following discovery of structural deficiencies; additionally, the court transferred \$9.6 million to fund 49 reserves specifically for jail renovation contingency and allocated \$1.5 million for Precinct 1 renovations. Following Commissioner David Tullos's request to identify areas for budget reduction given the \$7 million increase over the prior year, the court agreed to reduce Road and Bridge new paved road miles from fifteen to ten miles while maintaining third seal work on existing roads and directing the department to explore additional stabilization of unpaved roads within the reduced budget, and agreed to defer the Road and Bridge development technician position to a future year while retaining the admin assistant position. Chad Mallett made a motion to increase the salary scale maximum for two department heads in IT and the Road Department by 3% to keep them within structure, with an agreement to conduct a comprehensive pay scale evaluation in the coming year. Seconded by Joe Fauth. Carried (4-0-1)

6 Consider and take action to establish the salary, expenses, and other allowances of elected County or precinct officers according to Local Government Code 152.011 and 152.013 for FY 2027. — Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

Joe Fauth presented the proposed budget for establishing salaries, expenses, and allowances for elected county and precinct officers for fiscal year 2027, noting that he had initially proposed a \$4 per hour increase for all elected officials but was reconsidering a reduction to \$3 per hour. Chad Mallett stated that elected officials should receive only the cost of living adjustment (COLA) and that any additional increases should be based on a comprehensive study, noting that the county's current salaries were at or above averages for similar counties. Joe Fauth indicated that his numbers were based on comparisons with 21 similar counties to Grimes County. After discussion, Chad Mallett clarified his position that a COLA-only increase should be implemented for the current budget year, with additional studies conducted later to evaluate further salary adjustments. Joe Fauth calculated that a \$2 COLA increase would result in an additional \$4,160 plus benefits for elected officials. Motion by Chad Mallett to establish the salary with a \$2 per hour increase for

all elected county and precinct officers, with the sheriff's position being supplemented by SB 22 funds to maintain a total gross salary of \$125,000, which was seconded by Michael Raska. Carried (5-0-0)
Local Government Code 152.011 and 152.013

Signature

Joe Fauth III, Grimes County Judge

ADJOURN

Motion by Commissioner Michael Raska. Seconded by Commissioner Chad Mallett. Carried (5-0-0).

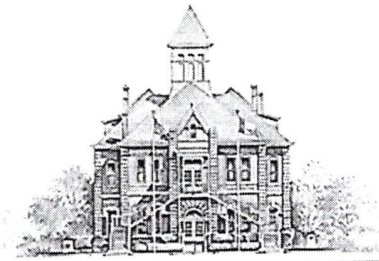
(11:58 AM)

THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT ON August 26th, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.

County Clerk Barbara Kimich

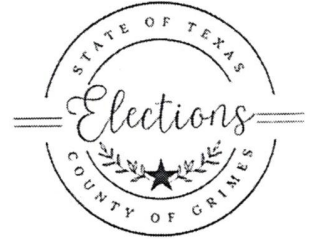
EXHIBITS

[Exhibit A — elections resolution.pdf](#)



Grimes County Elections

100 S Main St / P.O. Box 375
Anderson, TX 77830
(936) 873-3940
elections@grimescountytexas.gov



A RESOLUTION OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT RECOGNIZING SEPTEMBER 15, 2026, AS NATIONAL VOTER REGISTRATION DAY IN GRIMES COUNTY, TEXAS

WHEREAS, the right to vote is a fundamental component of our democratic process, and voter registration is an essential first step in ensuring that eligible citizens are able to exercise that right; and

WHEREAS, National Voter Registration Day is a nonpartisan civic observance dedicated to encouraging eligible citizens to register to vote, verify their voter registration information, and participate in the electoral process; and

WHEREAS, National Voter Registration Day has been observed nationally since 2012 and brings together election officials, civic organizations, schools, libraries, businesses, and community partners to promote voter registration and civic participation; and

WHEREAS, Grimes County recognizes the importance of providing accurate, reliable, and accessible information regarding voter registration and the electoral process to the citizens of Grimes County; and

WHEREAS, the Grimes County Elections Department is committed to promoting election integrity, voter education, accessibility, and public confidence in the electoral process through nonpartisan voter-registration and voter-information efforts; and

WHEREAS, encouraging eligible citizens to register to vote and maintain accurate voter registration information strengthens civic participation and helps ensure that qualified citizens are prepared to participate in future elections; and

WHEREAS, Tuesday, September 15, 2026, has been designated nationally as National Voter Registration Day, providing an opportunity for communities across the country to promote voter registration and civic participation;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Grimes County Commissioners Court hereby recognizes Tuesday, September 15, 2026, as National Voter Registration Day in Grimes County, Texas; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Grimes County Commissioners Court encourages all eligible citizens of Grimes County to register to vote, verify that their voter registration information is current and accurate, and participate in the electoral process; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that Grimes County encourages community organizations, schools, businesses, civic groups, and other community partners to support nonpartisan voter-registration and voter-education efforts throughout Grimes County; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Grimes County Elections Department is encouraged to participate in and promote National Voter Registration Day through appropriate nonpartisan voter-registration and voter-education activities.

PASSED, APPROVED, AND ADOPTED by the Grimes County Commissioners Court this 26th day of August, 2026.



Joe Fauth III
County Judge
Grimes County, Texas

Chad Mallett
Commissioner, Precinct 1

David Tullos
Commissioner, Precinct 2

Michael Raska
Commissioner, Precinct 3

Phillip Cox
Commissioner, Precinct 4

ATTEST:

Barbara Kimich
County Clerk
Grimes County, Texas